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A HUMOROUS HISTORY OF ENGLAND

THE ESSENTIALS OF ENGLAND'S
HISTORY TOLD IN RHYME

LIGHT
AND
AMUSING

TOLD AND
PICTURED

BY
HARRISON.

PRICE
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WITH FORTY EIGHT
ILLUSTRATIONS



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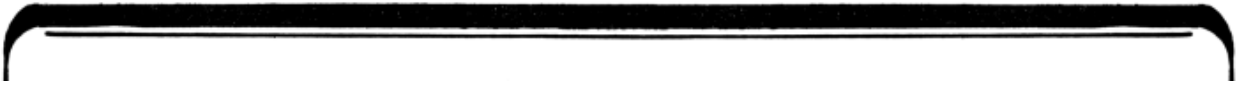
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OF ENGLAND ***



ad1 CONCERNING

Anæmia

(Poorness of Blood.)

IN MEN AND WOMEN,

BY THE LATE

DR. ANDREW WILSON.

The public are very familiar with the term “Anæmia,” and this fact alone testifies to the extremely common nature of the ailment thus indicated.

As a rule Anæmia shows a gradual progress. There is experienced a feeling of lassitude, of being “easily tired out,” and a distaste for active exertion. The digestion is enfeebled, and, without feeling actually ill, the sufferer inclines towards an inactive life, while the appetite usually disappears, and a general bodily upset is represented. The lips are pale, the red of the eyelids, seen by turning down the lower eyelid, will exhibit a similar appearance. Breathlessness is another notable sign; the least exertion, going upstairs for instance, causes the sufferer to pant, because the heart, not being supplied with blood of good quality, cannot perform its work properly. The pulse is weak and irregular.

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NERVINESS, Men find the Ideal Tonic
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TOLD AND PICTURED

BY

C. HARRISON

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1920.



AN AFTER-DINNER SPEECH
IN YE OLDEN TIME.
(AND ANY OTHER TIME.)



BOADICEA.

Preface "Arms and the man" was Virgil's strain; But we
propose in lighter vein
To browse a crop from pastures (Green's) Of England's
Evolution scenes.
Who would from facts prognosticate The future progress of this
State,
Must own the chiefest fact to be Her escalator is the Sea.



H Prehistoric HISTORIANS erudite and sage, When writing
of the past stone age,
 Tell us man once was clothed in skins And tattooed
 patterns on his shins.
Rough bearded and with shaggy locks He lived in dug-outs in
 the rocks.
Was often scared and run to earth By creatures of abnormal
 girth:
Mammoths and monsters; truth to tell We find their names too
 long to spell.
He joined in little feuds no doubt; And with his weapons
 fashioned out
Of flint, went boldly to the fray; And cracked a skull or two
 per day.

W Druids E read of priests of Celtic day, Ancient Druids,
 holding sway
 By smattering of Occult law And man's eternal sense of
 awe.
Stonehenge They used Stonehenge on Salisbury Plain Reputed
 Prehistoric Fane;
Note each megalithic boulder; No Monument in Europe's
 older.





M **Phœnicians** **ERCHANT** explorers of that day, Hustling
 Phœnicians, came this way
 To ship tin ore from Cornish mines Three thousand years
 before these lines.
 But still in spite of petty strife Man lived what's termed the
 'simple life'
Julius Cæsar B.C. 55 Till Julius Cæsar in five-five With his
 galleys did arrive.
 He wrote despatches of the best, 'Veni, Vidi' and the rest,
 Sending the news of victory home; And flags then fluttered
 high in Rome.
 His 'photo' one plain fact discloses He brought in fashion
 Roman noses.
 Of this great General 'tis allowed The best 'Life' is by J. A.
 Froude.
Boadicea A.D. 62 Boadicea earns our praise. First woman leader
 in those days;
 For Freedom strove all she could do, 'Twas lost in A.D. sixty-
 two.
Agricola Then came Agricola one day And gained a battle near
 the Tay.

He started trimming up this isle, And laid out roads in Roman style.

East, North, South, West, it's safe to say His handiwork is traced to-day.

The Natives too were taught to know By busy merchants' constant flow

The wisdom that great Empire held; Their ignorance was thus dispelled.

Romans left A.D. 410 About four hundred-ten A.D. The Romans left sans cérémonie.

Can it be wondered at when Rome Was needing help 'gainst Huns at home.

Our antiquarians often find The relics which they left behind;
A Villa here and pavement there, Coins galore and Roman ware.



A Anglo-Saxons A.D. 430 ND so we run our flippant rhymes
Right on to Anglo-Saxon times.

Hengist and Horsa with their men Came from their Jutish pirate den,

Jutes And paid us visits in their ships Bent on their ruthless looting trips.

And Angles landing in the Humber Gave that district little slumber.

They plundered morning, noon, and night, Were rough, uncouth, and impolite,



O **Alfred 872–901** F good King Alfred we’ve all heard How
 when hiding he incurred
 A lady’s anger for not taking Care of Cakes which she
 was baking.
 (Most probably she left the King While she went out a-
 gossiping.)
 Before he died in nine-nought-one, Old England’s Navy had
 begun.
 He laid a tax on every town To aid his fleet to gain renown.
 He was the best of Saxon Kings And did a lot of useful things;
 Built Oxford with its noble spires And mapped out England
 into Shires.

I **Danes 783** N seven-eight-three first came the Danes Who
 caused the Saxons aches and pains.
 They sailed right up our rivers broad, Putting the natives
 to the sword.
“Danegeld” 991 For centuries our sadly fated Towns by them
 were devastated.
 Etheldred the ‘Unready Toff’ By ‘Danegeld’ tries to buy them
 off.

IRON JELLOIDS
The Great Tonic



T Canute 1014–1036 WO hundred years the raiding Danes
Came over. Then their Canute reigns.
We'll merely mention that he tried An object lesson with
the tide.

Hardicanute 1039–1041 Hardicanute, sad to confess, Died from
drinking to excess.
He couldn't conquer love of wine And with him went the
Danish line.

E Edward the Confessor 1041–1066 DWARD the Confessor staid
The Saxon line renewed. Remade
At Westminster the Abbey grand, And signed the first
'Will' in this land.
And since his time ('tis not refuted) Scores of Wills have been
disputed.
Ah! legal quibbles such as these Mean Lawyers waxing rich on
fees.

H Harold 1066 AROLD last of the Saxon line At Hastings
made an effort fine
And lost his life—it was to be, Crushed by the men of
Normandy.
From Scandinavia they'd come, And made fair Normandy their
home;

William the Conqueror 1066–1087 Whence William spying out our
shore, Oliver-Twist-like, wanted more.
In ten-six-six he won the day In that tough fight out Hastings
way.
Of course, no record in our reach, Depicts 'ole Bill' thus on the
beach.





B William the Conqueror 1066–1087 UT one thing's certain. Camera
men, If only they'd existed then,
Would have journeyed many a mile To 'snap' King
William's happy smile.

They made him King and schoolbooks say He ruled with
arbitrary sway;

Demanding with sharp battle axes Instant payment of big
taxes.

Curfew And p'raps it's just as well to tell He introduced the
Curfew Bell;

So at the early hour of eight Each doused his glim, raked out
his grate.

In bed at eight P.M. each day Life was but sombre, dull and
grey;

No cutting fancy ball room capers, No Cinemas or evening
papers.

He was a bully it is true, But to allow him his just due
He made reforms; he also took In hand the bulky Doomsday
book.

IN William's time we're glad to write People began to be
polite;

Ladies curtsied to their beaux, Who smartly raised their
gay chapeaux.

The Jews The Jews he introduced from Spain Bringing much
knowledge in their train
Of Arts and Science; but 'Longshanks' Expelled them with no
word of thanks.

Feudalism These were the well known Feudal days, Tenants
were slaves in many ways
To mighty Lords who owned the land And ruled them with an
iron hand.
Not free from duties were the Lords, The King could call upon
their swords
And men to fight in time of need. So feudal laws of old
decreed.

W **William Rufus 1087–1100** ILLIAM Rufus or the 'Red' In
ten-eight-seven ruled instead;
This may be; but we know, alack, Though he was red his
deeds were black.

Crusades 1095 The first Crusade in ten-nine-five, A million
men, a very hive,
Swarm to the East, the Holy plain From the Mohammedans to
gain.

H **Henry I. 1100–1135** ENRY the First, of wisdom rife, Saxon
Matilda makes his wife,
Saxon and Norman line uniting, A learned chap who
loved not fighting.

S **Stephen 1135–1154** TEPHEN of Blois ascends the throne And
'gainst Matilda holds his own;
Grandson of the Conqueror; Died in eleven-fifty-four.

H **Henry II. 1154–1189** ENRY the Second claims our rhyme
'The hardest worker of his time';
A wiser King we never had Nor father with his sons so
bad.

Becket This the first 'Plantagenet' King With Becket strove
like anything;

Church v. Crown Which should be Master, Church or Crown
Pull-King Pull-Bishop; both went down.

Thomas was murdered by four Knights On steps of Altar—
 Sorry wights:
With bleeding feet the King atones By pilgrimage to Becket's
 bones.
Despite his struggles with the Church He knocked the barons
 off their perch,
Fifteen hundred Castles razing In a manner quite amazing.
Law Trial by jury further grows; The King's Court in this
 reign arose;
Our Parliaments from this proceed And all our other Courts
 indeed.
Linen Linen's first used in twelve-five Woollens alone in
 vogue before.
Glass Windows In eleven-eight-nought first came to pass The
 novelty of window glass.
And doubtless playful little boys Full of children's simple joys,
Cracked as our youngsters often do With stones or ball a pane
 or two.
Richard Cœur de Lion 1189–1199 Cœur de Lion from one Crusade
 Returning was a prisoner made.
But Blondel played an Air he knew, The King joined in; Voilà
 the clue.
This catchy tune in a pleasant key Opened the door to liberty.



A **John 1199–1216** ND so we'll quickly journey on Until we
reach the reign of John;

A King whose list of crimes was heavy; He treated badly
his young 'Nevvy'.

Magna Charta 1215 He signed the Magna Charta. Yes; In twelve-
fifteen, but we may guess

With much ill grace and many a twist; For King John wrote an
awful fist.

John loses Normandy to France And by this beneficial chance
In England comes amalgamation; Normans and Saxons form
one Nation

Robin Hood And now we come to Robin Hood, The Forest
bandit of Sherwood,

A popular hero much belauded But not by folks whom he'd
defrauded.

There's no need to descant upon His boon companion 'Little
John';

Or 'Friar Tuck' so overblown He tipped the scale at fifteen
stone.

A **Henry III. 1216–1272** ND what of Henry number Three, The
King who suffered poverty?

It's very awkward we must own To be 'hard up' when on
a Throne;



To have to scrape up an amount To pay the butcher on account,
Or ask a dun in Kingly way To kindly call some other day.

Coinage 1257 In twelve-five-seven it is stated Gold was coined
and circulated,
Ha'pence and farthings just before; In those times worth a
great deal more.

Langton Died 1228 The Bible which from over seas Had no
chapters and no verses
Was by Archbishop Langton's skill Divided as we use it still.



Why was it Henry III. allowed At court a huge rapacious
crowd
To drain his coffers nearly dry Flattering with cajolery?



M Astrology ANY simple folk, (it's queer) Used to
 patronise the seer
 And pay cash down for magic spell Perchance a
 Horoscope as well.
 Or open wide at special rate That musty tome the Book of
 Fate;
 Or seek the Philtre's subtle aid To win the hand of some fair
 maid.
 We mus'nt miss the Troubadours Who went forth on their
 singing tours,
 Twanging harps and trilling lays To maids of medieval days.
 And Oh! the right good merry times With Maskers, Mummers
 and the Mimes,
 Hobby horses gaily prancing, Bats and Bowls and Maypole
 dancing.
 When folks would take a lengthy journey To see the Knights at
 Joust or Tourney:
 Or watch the early English 'Knuts' Show their skill at Archery
 butts.
 Then come gloomy History pages On torture of the Middle
 ages;
 The clanking fetters grim and black, The thumbscrew and the
 awful rack,
 The horrors of the dungeon deep Beneath the moat or castle
 keep,

Rusty locks and heavy keys And—let us change the subject,
please.

First House of Commons twelve-six-five, At Westminster they
all arrive.

Simon de Montfort 1265 Simon de Montfort was the man Who
'engineered' this useful plan.

And we can picture these M.P.s Newly fledged and ill at ease
Doing their level best to try To catch the embryo speaker's eye.



E **Edward I. 1272-1307** EDWARD First 'Longshanks' nicknamed
For his lengthy stride far-famed.

Here he is in twelve-seven-two Bounding along with
much ado.

A Soldier, Statesman and a King His lofty ideals picturing
That England, Scotland, Wales all three, United should one
country be.



First Prince of Wales 1282 In twelve-eight-two annexes Wales;
Where afterwards no strife prevails.
He promised a Prince with English So gave his new-born
speechless son.



N Edward I. 1272–1307 (continued) EXT Scotland Edward tries to
 tackle No easy task the Scotch to shackle;
 Wallace and Bruce resistance make, The King dies ere he
 gains the stake.

In Edward's reign some author writes They first used candle
 dips for lights;

And coal came in about this date Mixed (as to-day) with lots of
 slate.



So Monarchs, Barons, Dukes and Knights Warmed their toes
 with Derby Brights;

But those in hovels had the smuts Arising from cheap Kitchen
 Nuts.

Roger Bacon 1293 Roger Bacon (ob. twelve-nine-three) Versed
was in arts of alchemy;
Gunpowder's composition knew; And many another chemic
brew.
Many Mortmain Acts are passed; Six centuries these efforts
last
To stop the hungry Hierarchy Devouring all the Squirearchy.
Lollards 1307 Lollards in thirteen-seven arose Popish rituals to
oppose;
John Wycliffe gives to old and young The Bible in the vulgar
tongue.
With John of Gaunt's protection strong He dared to preach
'gainst cleric wrong;
Precursor of the Reformation To liberal thought attuned the
nation.

E **Edward II. 1307–1327** EDWARD the Second with his minions
Governs badly these dominions

Edward III. 1327–1377 His son a man of different mould
Was Edward Three, both wise and bold.
Through clinging to their French domains Our Kings are
French through many reigns
And Edward fighting in this cause Commenced a hundred
years of Wars.
A century's struggle. For our pains Only Calais town remains.
French Wars A century after this 'twas lost, In Mary's reign.
Oh! what a frost.

Weaving 1331 In thirteen-three-one England's taught Weaving
by men from Flanders brought.
Ryghte goode cloth with lots of 'body' The world was then not
up to 'shoddy.'
Blanket of Bristol in this year Invented blankets for our cheer;
And since that time its been our boast Our beds have been as
warm as toast.
Edward 'Black Prince' One-three-four-six, A brave and noble
warrior, 'licks'
Crecy 1346 The valiant French in Crecy's fray; Cannon first
used upon this day,
Causing panic with their rattle; But the Yeomen win the battle,

For, flicking arrows from their bows They ‘filled the air as
when it snows.’

Thereon the English Calais seize And of the channel hold the
keys;

The Spanish pirates bend the knee Then Edward III’s ‘King of
the sea.’

Parliament 1376 Lords and Commons from this date Have their
meetings separate,

The Commons first a Speaker make The Chancellors the
Woolsack take.

Ten lady members have the Lords But doubtless fearful of their
words,

Or thinking it not orthodoxy, They only let them vote by proxy.

While Church and Barons have their squabbles The House of
Commons more power nobbles;

On laws and taxes dares speak out And give the Pope the right-
about.



L Leasing EASING or Farming, we are taught, Was
introduced 'bout twelve-nought-nought;
The Feudal system's weakened and The Tenants 'usufruct'
the land.

On various counts the serfs go free And work for wages
(Edward Three).

The Black Death and the foreign wars In labour ranks
commotion cause;

Strikes and craftsmen's combination Then arise among the
nation;

These movements preached by one John Ball, Who, born too
soon, was hanged withal.

N Richard II. 1377-1399 OW comes the Second Richard's reign.
It is recorded very plain
That he was full of discontent Quarrelling with his
Parliament.



Poll Tax 1380 With his taxes super-sated The peasants grew exasperated;
 They threw their spades and pitchforks down And marched as rebels into town.
 Thirteen-eighty's Poll taxation Puts equal tax on all the nation;
 Lays seven thousand peasants dead; Wat Tyler and Jack Straw at head.
Præmunire Præmunire Act is passed To check the Papal Bulls at last.
Chaucer Chaucer the Poet this same year Makes Pilgrimage to Becket's bier.



Age of Chivalry This was the age, aye verily, Of ryghte goode noble chivalry,
 When Knights went forth through storm and stress To rescue beauty in distress.



Or sallied out in valiant way A monster dragon for to slay,
Or with lance or trusty blade Defend from harm the hapless
 maid.

H **Henry IV. 1399–1413** ENRY Four, called ‘Bolingbroke’ In
Richard’s wheel puts many a spoke;
 Compels him to resign the throne Which thereupon he
 makes his own.

Through John of Gaunt, Lancastrian famed, His title to the
 crown he claimed;

The Parliament confirms his right And thus he’s king without a
 fight.

Lollards 1401 In this reign persecution’s turned Against the
 Lollards—Cobham’s burned.

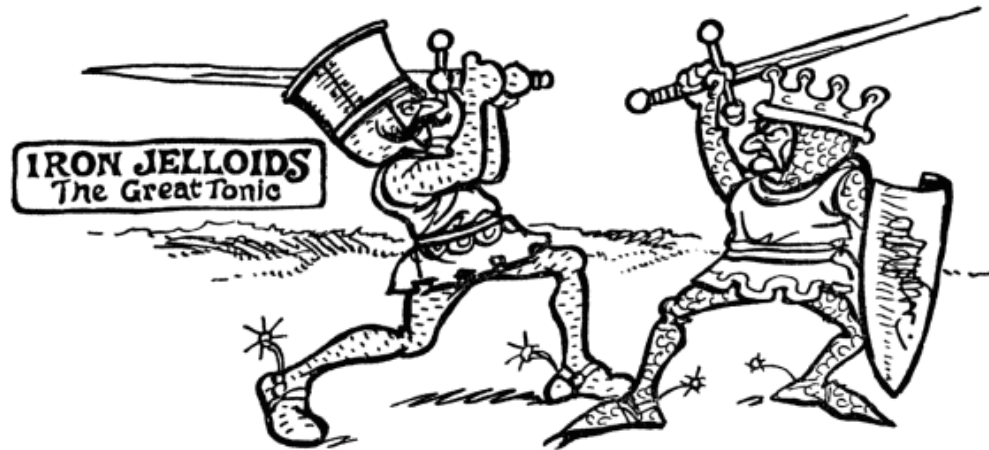
Incredible! The records show A statute ‘de Comburondo.’

F **Henry V. 1413–1422** ROM fourteen-thirteen, Henry Five, For
many years with France did strive;
 His Widow founds the Tudor House By taking Owen for
 her spouse.

H **Henry VI. 1422–1461** ENRY Six, next in our rhymes, For
fifty years had troublous times;
 Wars of Roses, Wars with France, The poor man never
 had a chance.

Joan of Arc 1430 Joan of Arc the peasant Maid Inspired the
 French with Mystic aid;
 Disunited, we make peace, All France but Calais we release.
Constantinople 1453 Constantinople's seized by Turks Causing
 Greek Scholars (with their works)
 To fly to Italy; and thence Learning's reborn—'The
 Renaissance.'

Edward IV. 1461–1483 N Edward Fourth, fourteen-six-one The
I House of York obtains the Throne.
 He wins at Towton's bloody fray, No quarter given on that
 day.
 Guy, Earl of Warwick in these frays Was always turning
 different ways;
Barnet 1471 On Barnet Field he met his doom The Rose of
 York's now well abloom.
 The Barons, Church and Commons fall, The King emerges
 Boss of all.
 Benevolences he exacts, An early form of Super Tax.
Earl of Warwick 'Kingmaker' was Earl Warwick styled With his
 manner scarcely mild
 He set Kings up and bowled them down Playing at ninepins
 with the Crown.



Wars of Roses 1485 White and Red Rose warring madly Bled the
 country very sadly,

Three-and-thirty years contending; At Bosworth Field we see
the ending.

Printing 1473 First in fourteen-seventy-three We print from type
in this Countree.

Now it is that time's first measured By monster watches
greatly treasured.

Thomas Parr this centurie His hundred-fifty years did see;
But Henry Jenkins, so 'tis said, In age was seventeen years
ahead.

Hoary patriarchs were these Retaining p'raps their faculties;
What a comfort 'tis to mention Neither drew the old age
pension.



PRINTING started through the Nation A taste for higher education;

Here is a citizen at home; Note his very brainy Dome.

Richard III. 1483–1485 ICHARD (Crookback) in fateful hour
Smothered his nephews in the Tower,
He murdered them the Crown to gain; A heavy price for
three years' reign.

The Scutcheon's blotted terribly Of this King Richard number
Three,

For it seems his recreation Was ordering decapitation.

1485 On Bosworth Field when sorely pressed He made a bid
th'uncommonest

'My kingdom for a horse' he cried; No offers coming, there he
died.

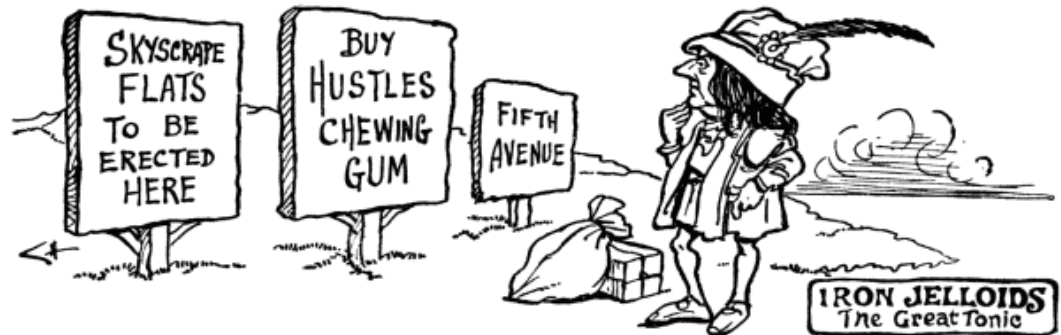
LHenry VII. 1485–1509 ANCASTRIAN Richmond wins the fight
And to make his title right

Elizabeth of York espouses, Thus uniting the two Houses.
This Henry Seven of Tudor line To misers' habits did incline;
Twelve millions stated to possess, A tidy little fortune! Yes!

Star Chamber Much he managed to extort By means of a Star
Chamber Court

From the rich nobles; A new wile For adding to the kingly pile.
With cash in hand he could attain His wish as Autocrat to
reign;

As sole possessor of the guns The King no risk from rebels
runs.



Columbus 1498 OLUMBUS, full of travellers' lore, By
going West sought India's shore;
But found America's wondrous land; His 'exes' paid by
Ferdinand.

Of voyagers we've now a lot Vasco da Gama and Cabot,
Who sailed from Bristol, whence it grew Bristolians claim this
fine cuckoo.



NHenry VIII. 1509–1547 OW Henry Eight comes on the screen,
A stalwart youth, ætat. eighteen;
With youthful hope the nation's buoyed; Only, alas! to be
destroyed.



T Henry VIII. 1509–1547 (continued) HIS King Henry number Eight
 Six times tried the married state;
 And certainly of all the Kings Spent the most on wedding
 rings.
 But to search through old Archives For tales of Henry and his
 wives

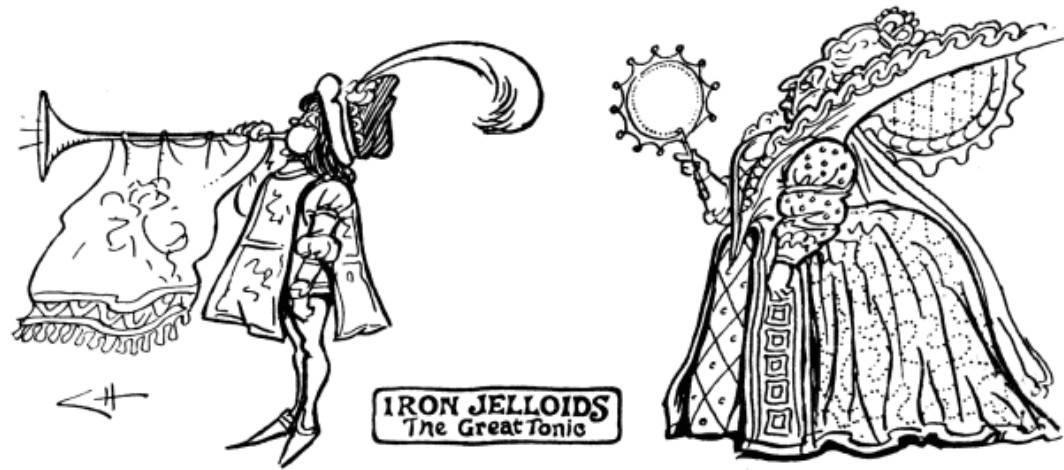
And all their little tiffs to trace We cannot spare the time or
space.

Yet there are some who fain would sing The praises of this
rotund King;

But as a husband we're afraid His category's lowest grade.

He wielded harsh the despot's power, And packed his wives off
to the Tower;

Consigned them to a fate most dreaded; Two, alas! he had
beheaded.



HAIL NOW TO THEE OUR GOOD QUEEN BESS! Henry VIII. (continued)

M **Reformation 1517** ARTIN Luther, fifteen-one-seven, Sows
his Reformation leaven;

It finds a culture medium here In the 'New Learning's'
atmosphere.

Of this New Learning More's the chief, Utopia's Author, He's
'mid grief

Beheaded, saying cool and calm, 'Cut not my beard, that's
done no harm.'

His friend Erasmus, Logic's Master, Trimmed his sails and
'scaped disaster.

A third, Dean Colet who St. Paul's School London into being
calls.

Wolsey 1530 In fifteen-thirty Wolsey great, A Cardinal and Man
of State,

From Butcher's son had risen high. Reader! consult your
Shakespeare nigh.

Blamed by some; by others praised; He fell; but still the pile he
raised

Most nobly graces Hampton Court. Give Wolsey then a tender
thought.

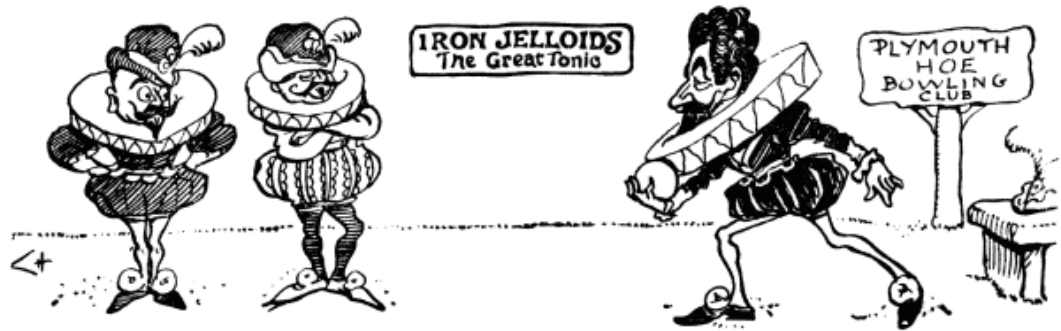
His main ambition that the King Should be supreme in
everything;

Thomas Cromwell And Thomas Cromwell followed suit To
make his master absolute
Head of the Church within his realm. These two most able at
the helm;
But not with skill enough endued To 'scape their King's
ingratitude.
Despotical the King's power grew. He's England's Pope by Act
of Su-
Premacy; as, to gain divorce, The foreign Pope is banned
perforce.
1537 Now Bluff King Harry gives the Monks A series of most
awful funks;
Three thousand odd of their domains He 'collars' for his
Courtiers' gains.

E **Edward VI. 1547–1553** DWARD Six to the throne succeeds A
pious youth of goodly deeds;
One, well known in the Capital, The Blue Coat School
(Christ's Hospital).

Q **Mary 1553–1558** UEEN Mary One, in Smithfield Square,
At Oxford, Gloucester and elsewhere,
Burned poor Martyrs by the score; The Romish faith she
would restore.

H **Elizabeth 1558–1603** AIL now to thee our good Queen Bess,
Garbed in the puffed and padded dress,
Farthingale and starched up frills, Meaning heavy laundry
bills.
Od's Bodikins; what monstrous ruffs, What gowns of rich
embroidered stuffs
Piped and scolloped, trimmed with furs, And shaped like huge
gasometers.
Now we've warfare of the Creeds, For their thoughts all
Europe bleeds;
Each party seeks by force to make The other side its faith
forsake.
Spain the Great Power of those days In these contentions first
part plays.



Drake Drake at bowls on Plymouth Hoe Left his game to meet
this foe

And came home laden we are told With seachests full of
Spanish gold.

Armada 1588 In fifteen-eight-eight Armada strong From Spain
to squash us comes along;

Which Howard, Frobisher and Drake And stormy weather
overtake.



A Shakespeare 1564–1616 ND in these epoch making days
 Shakespeare wrote and staged his plays;
 Weaving a thread whose magic strands Entwine all
 English-speaking lands.
 Fifteen-eight-seven Scots' Queen Mary Lost her head through
 fate contrary.
 When Henry Eight had robbed the Church 'Twas found the
 poor were in the lurch;
Poor Law A law was passed about this date To place the poor
 upon the rate.



Sir Walter Raleigh 1552–1618 IR Walter Raleigh, best of Knights,
 The first to taste the keen delights

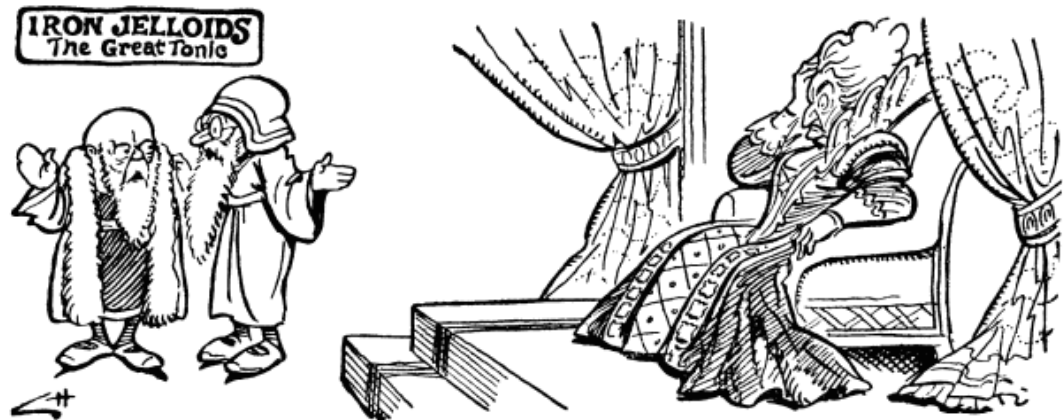
Of the enchantress so serene, The Ryghte Goode Ladye
Nicotine.

No information's yet to hand Concerning Raleigh's favourite
brand;

Tobacco Was it coarse-cut shag which burns The tongue, or
birdseye or returns?



Queen Elizabeth Good Queen Bess we understand Had crowds
of suitors for her hand;
And here we beg to give a view Of suitors waiting in a queue.



A Queen Elizabeth (continued) S time rolled on this Good Queen
 Bess Lost somewhat of her sprightliness;
 She got into a nervous state Was mopish and disconsolate.
 Now, as everyone will own, Had 'Iron Jelloids' been but
 known
 In Bess's time; why, it's conceded 'Twas just the Tonic that she
 needed.

East India Company 1600 The great 'John Comp'ny' now began
 Its fine career without a plan.
 Great! The Elizabethan Age. In History's book a glorious page.



Somewhere or other we've heard snuff Came in the days of
frill and ruff;
And here's a noble ill at ease Giving the first recorded sneeze.

J **James I. 1603–1625** AMES Six of Scotland, miscalled a 'fule'
As James One of England comes to rule.

Gramercy! 'tis a canny thing To be a 'double-barrelled'
King.

The son of Mary Queen of Scots Of learning he had lots and
lots,

Writing sundry ponderous books 'Gainst 'bacca, witches and
their spooks.

James thought his kingly power divine And, loathing Puritanic
'whine,'

He vowed to make them all comply Or else he'd 'know the
reason why.'

Pilgrim Fathers 1620 His persecution to escape Some Zealots in
the 'Mayflower' shape

Their course for an uncharted world Where Freedom's Flag
could be unfurled.

These 'Pilgrim Fathers' found a state 'New England,' blessed
with happy fate.

Folks have called the first King James Most uncomplimentary
names;

To wit 'a sloven' and 'a glutton'; Perhaps his weakness was
Scotch Mutton.

And as to gluttony, 'Gadzooks'! If what we read in History
books

Is true, they all were trenchermen; There were no diet faddists
then.

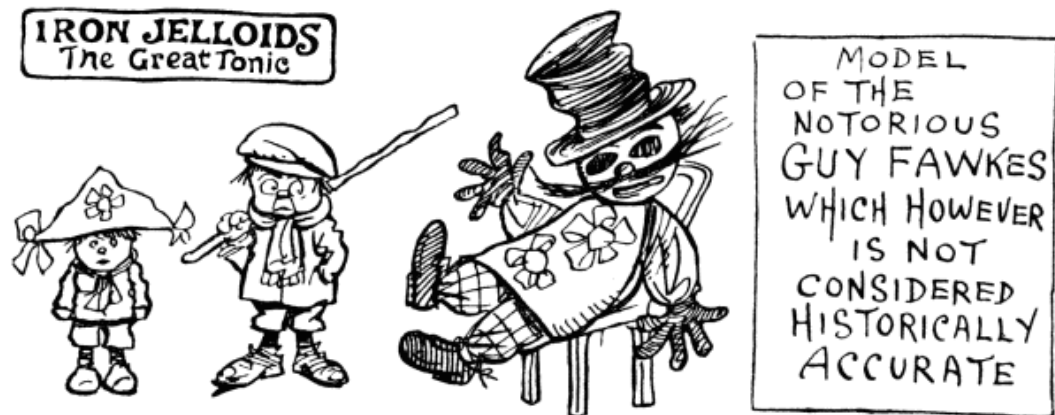
It startles us, one must declare, To read their breakfast bill of
fare;

All 'Kynes' of ale, some highly spiced And divers meats, roast,
boiled and sliced.

In James' reign a man could get For money down a coronet
And titles with the greatest ease Like folks to-day buy soap and
cheese.

Harvey Yet a learned time; for Harvey shows That blood's not
stagnant, but it flows;

Lord Bacon ‘Experiment!’ Lord Bacon cries ‘There is no
progress otherwise.’



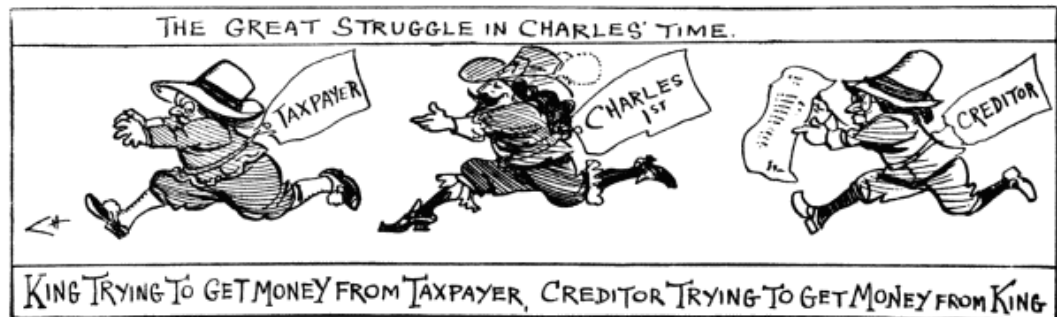
On 5th November 1605 F troubles James had quite a lot, For instance the Gunpowder Plot.
It fizzled out but left to-day A liking for Firework display.



So rockets with their sweeping curves, Crackers which upset the nerves
And squibs with their infernal din To this date owe their origin.

His son Charles One we understand Ruled England with a grasping hand;
For he was never loth to levy Taxes burdensome and heavy.
He moved in an expensive set, Was always heavily in debt;

And also photographic views, 'Sporting pars' and 'Stop-press News.'





THAT QUIET MAN, KNOWN AS THE EARLY PURITAN.

Cotton 1630 OTTON first came from India's shore In
 sixteen-thirty, less or more;
 Where for three thousand years it grew, Also in Egypt and
 Peru.
 Grim reading is the note confessing Gangs went out for Navy
 pressing,
 Forcing many a timid knave To spend his life on ocean wave.
Ship Money 1636 Charles raises the ship money tax; He thought
 he only had to 'ax';
 When Hampden strenuously objected, The King was very
 much affected.
Strafford 1641 Earl Strafford ('Thorough') in his pride 'The
 King shall rule the Commons' cried;
 The Commons would not brook such stuff And cut his head
 off. 'Quantum Suff.'
 The 'Grand Remonstrance' is put forth By the Commons who
 are wrath
 With the King's despotic ways Quite unsuited to these days.
 The King tries hard to put in jail Five Members but without
 avail;
 Hollis, Strode, Haslerig and Pym And Hampden (we must
 mention him);

They're guarded from the Royal hands By Watermen and City
Bands.

The 'die is cast' and Civil War For seven long years the Nation
tore.

Civil Wars 1642–1648 ROMWELL greatest of the foemen
With his faithful English Yeomen;
These 'Roundheads' sober, grim, religious To 'Cavaliers'
gave blows prodigious.

Their character's seen in the cry 'Trust God and keep your
powder dry.'

Naseby 1645 The Cavaliers and Roundheads fought In many a
field, 'till Naseby brought
To Generals Cromwell and Fairfax A crowning victory, though
not 'pax.'

The King's beheaded, but the State Experiences no headless
fate;

A commonwealth's forthwith proclaimed And Cromwell's
soon Protector named.

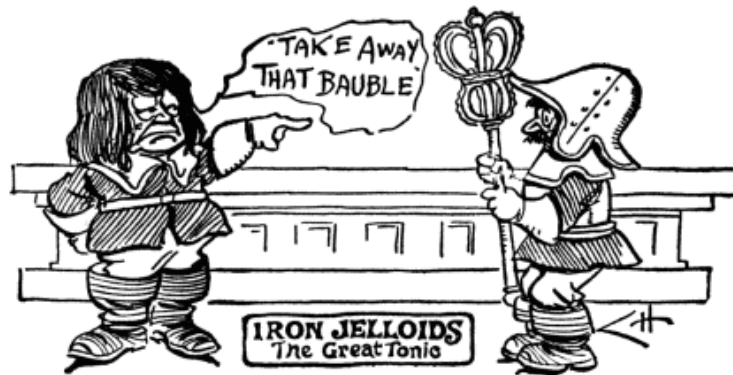
Dunbar 1650 In sixteen-fifty Dunbar sees The Royal Scots
brought to their knees;
And in the second Worcester fight Cromwell for good asserts
his might.

Worcester 1651 And there are those who love to tell About that
day at Boscobel
When Charles the Second's Majestye Found itself doubly 'up a
tree.'

And now we meet that quiet man Known as the early Puritan;
Mild and placid in his talk, Calm and measured in his walk.



Commonwealth 1649–1660 Oliver Cromwell bluff and bold, Was
 cast in Nature's sternest mould,
 Lacking maybe the courtly grace And proud of warts upon his
 face.
 He fought the Irish and the Scotch And with his navy beat the
 Dutch
 Let all his faults condonéd be, He kept us up on land and sea.



H Commonwealth (continued) E seemed to like bold argument
 And wordy wars with Parliament;
 He made things lively we infer Frequently at Westminster.



With M.P.s he had many a bout And one day cleared the whole
 lot out;
 Locked the door and took the key; Those not the days of 'Wait
 and See.'

C Charles II. 1660–1685 ROMWELL'S death brings Restoration
 And Charles Two lands 'mid acclamation.
 After his leaps from twig to twig He now has 'Otium cum
 Dig.'

In merry Charles the Second's age Woman first acted on the
 stage;
 The King encouraged much this vogue He was a pleasure
 seeking rogue.
 'He never said a foolish thing, Nor did a wise one'; this the
 King
 Countered with 'My words my own My acts my ministers'
 alone';
 1662 In sixteen-six-two year of grace, Charles taxed every
 fire-place;
 And citizens who couldn't pay Shivered and grumbled as to-
 day.
 These were the times of Musketeers And proud and dashing
 Cavaliers;
 When words were few and tempers hot And duels fought out
 on the spot.

T **John Bunyan** HE tinker preacher Bunyan wrote The
 'Pilgrim's Progress' we still quote,
 The prison bars no barrier wrought To lowly Bunyan's
 lofty thought.

Milton 1678 In stately language Milton's muse The Bible story
 doth diffuse;
 From 'Paradise Lost' we get our view Of Adam and Eve and
 Satan too.
 The Reverend Titus Oates, a scamp, Egregious Popish plots did
 vamp,
 Lied roundly for dishonest gains, Got Cat-o'-nine-tails for his
 pains.

Habeas Corpus 1679 The 'Habeas Corpus' best of laws Shields us
 from prison without cause;
 'Twas passed in sixteen-seventy-nine, And means 'Produce
 him here,' in fine.

Van Tromp Admiral Van Tromp, Dutchman bold, With broom
 at masthead, so 'tis told,
 The Channel sailed, suggesting he's Swept all the English from
 the seas.

Blake But Blake laughed loud and spread his sails Nought the
 Dutchman now avails;
 For he got an awful shocker Right to Davy Jones' locker.

But though the Dutch failed to invade, They were not
disinclined to trade;
So we get ‘Hollands,’ cheese and hams Fresh from the land of
Dykes and Dams.

Peace of Breda 1667 For fifteen years these Navies fought, ’Till
sixteen-six-seven respite brought;
The Peace of Breda then succeeded; New York to England was
conceded.

Plague In sixty-five the Plague appears And then the Fire; two
awful years

Fire of London 1665–1666 For London—And if more you’d know
Consult the Pages of Defoe.



QUEEN ANNE AND THE DUKE OF MARLBOROUGH.

W **James II. 1685–1688** HEN Charles Two died his brother James
 Soon put the country into flames;
 Papistry he would advance, And for that purpose
 leagued with France.
 In sixteen-eight-eight his bigot zeal Religious Test Act would
 repeal;
 Seven bold Bishops who defied To the Tower were sent and
 tried.
 The country raised a hue and cry So off to France the King
 doth fly.

H **William III. 1689–1702** IS place is filled by William Three
 His son-in-law from Dutch countree.
 This Orange sprig most brave of men With Mary reigns
 and all things then
 Went well with us. Macaulay's page Hails him as Hero of the
 age.
 In this reign of William Three, Laws were harsh 'gainst
 burglary;
 For they'd a very drastic way And hanged the 'Bill Sykes' of
 that day.
National Debt 1694 In sixteen-nine-four we have heard The
 National Debt was first incurred;
 To careful folk who would invest 'Twas not devoid of interest.

Another National Debt we owe To Iron Jelloids which the foe
Depression's worries keep at bay And drive our nervous fears
away.

Bill of Rights 1689 The 'Bill of Rights,' a Charter grand, In
sixteen-eight-nine frees this land
From all encroachments of the Crown Hoi Polloi are no longer
down.

G **Queen Anne 1702–1714** OOD Queen Anne we know is dead;
She reigned twelve years but it is said
'Mrs. Morley,' Marlborough's wife Ruled her more than
half her life.

Marlborough This was the Duke of Marlborough's day, Who
beat the French in every fray;
Known for his famous victories At Blenheim and at Ramillies.
In seventeen-seven by statute passed English and Scotch unite
at last;

'One coinage and one Parliament' Both Nations ever since
content.

About this time, so runs the story, Much is heard of 'Whig and
Tory';

And shortly after there was rife Many a sign of party strife.

Dr. Watts 1674–1748 Good Dr. Watts' moral lays Were much
reputed in these days;

And still we lisp at Mother's knee 'How doth the little Busy
Bee.'

Pope 1688–1744 Pope, letter-writer and great poet, Most
quotable of all (ye know it),
At Twickenham penned his caustic verse Epigrammatic,
smooth and terse.

T **George I. 1714–1727** HE House of Stuart being ended,
George of Hanover (descended
From daughter of King Jamie One) Comes over to ascend
our throne.

Of English George knew not a word, Most awkward, not to say
absurd,

At Cabinet Councils to preside; So from this time the practice
died.

H **George II. 1727–1760** IS son George Two succeeding then In
person fought at Dettingen.

Both these Kings had various fights In Scotland with the
Jacobites.

William Tull brings in Post Chaises; Now the people ride like
‘blazes.’;

Many can’t for they’re in trouble, Ruined by the South Sea
Bubble.

Wesleys 1703–1791 John and Charles Wesley, men of mind,
Revive Religion in Mankind.

Founding a Church both broad and low, One-seven-three-
nought A. Domini.

Clive 1746 Beginning as an office clerk As soldier Clive soon
made his mark,

And conquered India for this Nation; Self ’stounded at his
moderation.

Bridgwater, Gilbert, Brindley, three Great Engineers this
Centurie,

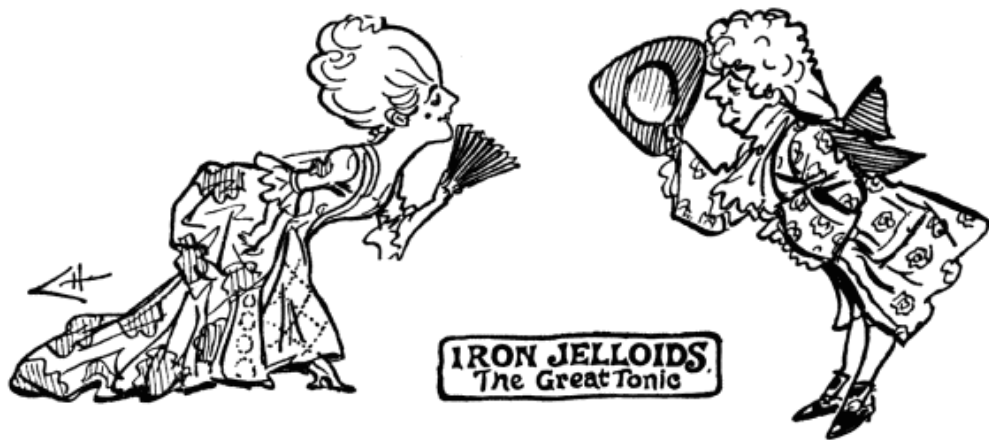
Canals Useful canals in England made, The flowing arteries of
trade.

Quebec 1759 General Wolfe seventeen-five-nine Captures
Quebec—a victory fine,

And Canada’s the splendid prize For old ‘John Bull’ to
colonise.

A **George III. 1760–1820** ND now of Georgey number Three:
Ut mulus obstinatus he

Had full sixty years of reign And a big family to train.



GEORGIAN TIMES.

W Georgian Times E will but very lightly scan The customs
 known as 'Georgian';
 The times of powdered Belles and Beaux; Patches, paint
 and furbelows;
 Of beauteous maids and gallants gay And merry routs at
 Ranelagh;
 Gaming parties, cards or pool And 'Fops' of the Beau
 Brummel School.



When rank and fashion History tells All took their cures
 among the Wells;
 And sipped in manner hesitating Daily doses nauseating.

But we know better how to act Our cures we purchase more
 compact
 For in the Chemists' you can see 'Iron Jelloids' priced at 'One
 and Three.'
 Lord 'Periwig' and gay 'Fallal' In Sedan Chairs frequent the
 Mall.
 'Taxis' and 'Tubes' we beg to state Came in at a much later
 date.
 When Brummel, the historic Beau, Made laws for dress and
 outward show;
 Whose vests were poems, whose coats were dreams Of
 gorgeous beauty, so it seems;
 Who figured in the public gaze A 'Star turn' with his courtly
 ways;
 Who fixed the style of a cravat, Lord of Appeal anent a hat.
 And My Lord Chesterfield was quite The model of the most
 polite
 Wrote famous letters. It's a shame, A settee has usurped his
 name.
Dr. Johnson 1709–1784 And Dr. Johnson at his ease Sipped his tea
 at the 'Cheshire Cheese,'
 Or at the 'Mitre' of renown, Spreading his wit throughout the
 Town.
Garrick When Garrick as the 'Moody Dane' Drew the Town to
 Drury Lane,
Mrs. Siddons Sarah Siddons was all the rage Tragedy Queen of
 every age.
 Highwaymen armed to the teeth Waited for prey on Hounslow
 Heath;
 Per contra the Highwayman's pate Was oft strung up at Tyburn
 Gate.
Capt. Cook 1728–1779 It's only right a History book Should mark
 the feats of Captain Cook;
 So jot it down in these our Rhymes That round the World he
 sailed three times.
Inventions 1767 These are the days of much invention The
 'Spinning Jenny' we will mention;
 The 'Cotton Mule' and 'Power Loom'; For Authors' names
 there's lack of room.

Adam Smith 1766 In his book 'The Wealth of Nations' Adam
Smith shows the relations
Governing the Art of Trading; With influences far pervading.
'Man buys as cheaply as he can And sells as dearly, that's his
plan.'
'Supply Demand each other feed Dearer markets cheap ones
bleed.'
Jenner 1796 Jenner brings in vaccination, Boon to every
generation;
By similar methods now devised Many an ill is exorcised.



NELSON AND WELLINGTON.

I **American War 1775** N seventeen-sixty and fifteen Our Taxes
raise the Yankees' spleen.

 'Unrepresented, you've no right To tax us, therefore we
 will fight.'

Washington, Franklin and the rest Formed a Republic quite the
best;

We've long been friends. Let us rejoice; But at the time we had
no choice.

I **French Revolution** N France in times of Louis Seize (says)
Oppression dire through countless days

 Roused Revolution with its tears Mainly through books
 with wrong ideas.

Napoleon I. 1793-1815 From Revolution's putrid mess A
Conqueror's born, quite conscienceless,

Millions of men and women died Victims to Napoleon's pride.
He plunged all Europe into Wars His own ambition the sole
cause.

England as usual did her 'bit' And 'Boney' Europe had to quit.
During these years of storm and stress Two noble pilots we
possess

'Chatham and Son' (Pitt is their name), Illustrious on the scroll
of fame.

Nelson 1805 Here we must our homage pay To Nelson of
 Trafalgar Day;
 Wellington To Wellington the same is due, Who crowned his
 fame at Waterloo.



AND 'Shiver my timbers,' 'Heave ahoy,' The Tar, those
 times a breezy boy
 With shiny hat and pigtail long And love for lass and glass
 and song.

Discovery of Electric Force About this date Electric Force Dawns
 on mankind. Before, of course,
 In Lightning it was all about, With noise enough to be found
 out.

Coelo eripuit fulmen, 'Twas said of Franklin, as ye ken.
 Philosopher of bygone age Accept our homage on this page.
 But who'd have thought it that Galvani When making soup,
 (this is no blarney)

By his power of observation On a frog's legs' oscillation
 Should find how by chemic ways Electric currents we can
 raise?

To call him 'great' is no flattery; He set us on the wondrous
 battery.

This simple little frog, Heigh Ho! The frog who would a-
 wooing go;

Thy part in electricity Is unmatched eccentricity.

This new discovered fact, of course, Leads to the Telegraph of
 Morse,

The Motor and Electric Light The Telephone and more in sight.



IN QUEEN VICTORIA'S PALMY DAYS.

O Ireland F Ireland but a word or two. Celts were her
 people and they knew
 Not benefit of Roman Ruling; Young Europa's Infant
 Schooling.
 In century five St. Patrick great Converts them to the Christian
 state;
 And from this Western Isle afar, English and Scotch converted
 are.
Danes and Ireland Two hundred years from nine-nought-nought
 Danes raiding Erin trouble brought;
 And left them in chaotic state No longer masters of their fate.
 In those days 'twas 'Woe to the weak,' Saxons and Danes had
 made us squeak,
 Then came the Normans in great force And civilised us in due
 course.
 They tried the same with Ireland green; But only sowed a feud
 between
 The land they'd conquered and Erin, Leading to endless
 quarrelling.
Cromwell England accepts the Reformation, Catholic still the
 Irish nation
Boyne Sees Cromwell with them battle join And William beat
 them at the Boyne.

William Pitt in eighteen-nought-nought Ireland and England's
welfare sought

Act of Union 1800 By 'Act of Union' which he passed; But still
the wretched squabbles last.

N **George IV.** OW come George Four and Will his brother;
With these two kings we need not bother;

William IV. The first a gourmand, bon viveur, The next a
sailor, bluff, sans peur.

Trevithick, Newcomen, and Watt Are names will never be
forgot;

For their crude engines were the source Of man's control of
Steam's wild force.

Steam 1830 By eighteen-thirty man has tamed Steam to his use;
and widely famed

Was puffing 'Rocket' with the power Of doing thirty miles an
hour.

Steam prompts man to make machines And Factories rise with
all that means;

Divided more and more is labour Each man leans more on his
neighbour.

For twenty million pounds the nation Buys our slaves'
emancipation.

Reform Act In eighteen-three-two, happy year, The great
Reform Act doth appear.

Steam vessels the Atlantic cross. The penny post comes into
force.

And double knocks bring joys and thrills Sometimes cheques,
more often bills.

Corn Law Repeal 1846 The Corn Law duty's brushed away,
Hence we enjoy cheap bread to-day.

WE fain would linger, but alas, These are the periods we
must pass.

So gentle reader do not grin At sight of cumbrous
crinoline.

Victoria 1837-1901 Since Queen Victoria's palmy days Woman
has altered all her ways.

In those days she was meek and mild And treated almost like a
child;

Woman's Status Was brought up in a narrow zone; And couldn't
call her soul her own.
She vegetated, 'tis well known Under the 'cloche' of
Chaperone.
But now the 'Franchise' she obtains, And her own property
retains.
What a difference from then, She 'carries on' just like the men.
And now at Westminster we see A lady sitting as M.P.

C Darwin 1809–1882 HARLES Darwin offers us a Key To
help unlock the mystery
Of Evolution's wondrous span From Protoplasm up to
Man.

Livingstone 1813–1873 The traveller, great Scotch Livingstone,
Wandered o'er Afric's trackless Zone;
Where no white man had ever trod Teaching the blacks the
Word of God.

Crimean War English, French and Turks unite 'Gainst Russia in
Crimean fight.

Indian Mutiny The Indian Mutiny now arose, 'Fat' was the
cause that led to blows.

Atlantic Cable With efforts many men most able Lay the great
Atlantic Cable.

Suez Canal Lesseps unites for you and me The Medit'anean
and Red Sea.

Education Act The Education Act proposes To make us all as
wise as Moses;

In eighteen-seven-nought it passed, But each is learning to the
last.

Ballot Act 1872 A couple of years from this we note The Ballot
Act gives secret vote;

Before this Act, e'en since we fear, Folks sold their votes for
draughts of beer.



WOMEN TOOK TO SPADE AND HOE.

E **Edward VII. 1901–1910** EDWARD Seven, 'Peacemaker' named,
His efforts to this end far famed.

We know it was no idle chance His 'Entente cordiale'
with France.

True friendship and the peace we want The outcome of this
grand Entente.

Though not accented in our rhyme We've been fighting all the
time;

And it's a fact which must be stated Our chief opponent (so
'twas fated)

Wars with France Our nearest neighbour o'er the Sea Whose
'No' is 'Non'; whose 'Yes' is 'Oui';

Like two schoolboys always sparring Eight hundred years
together warring;

From Hastings unto Waterloo We'd battles with the brave
'Mossoo.'

Now Honi soit qui still y pense; Hurrah for England! Vive la
France!

A **ND** here we come to end our rhymes We've reached the
present stirring times,

When one and all lent helping hand To keep secure the
Motherland.

When men went forth to fight the foe And women took to
spade and hoe,

And donning smocks of nattiest styles, Worked on the land for
Farmer Giles.
Now three cheers for the dainty maids, Government clerks of
different grades;



Nor are we likely to forget Our debt to the Munitionette.
The Present Time We seem to have subdued the Hun And so
farewell (our task is done)
To Anzacs-Indians-Poilus-Yanks— Italians-Belgians-Japs-and-
Tanks.



ad2

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Details of minor typographical corrections and retained mis-spellings are provided in the source code (search for `class="TN"`).



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HISTORY OF ENGLAND ***

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